



MAYAWATI

LUCKNOW | Growing Stash

When Mayawati filed her nomination papers for the 2007 legislative council elections, she had declared assets worth Rs 52 crore. This was when she had been under the CBI scanner in a disproportionate assets case. This year when the time came for her to declare her net worth with legislative elections due again, she was richer by Rs 35 crore. The Hindi heartland strong-woman is now worth Rs 87 crore. This translates into a saving of Rs 1 crore each month in her three years as chief minister of Uttar Pradesh. Mayawati claims she has given all details of income to the "concerned authorities" and that "all politicians should declare their assets". BJP spokesperson Hridaya Narain Dixit's response to her statement came with a chuckle: "She should also say that other politicians should also learn to make money like her."

by Subhash Mishra

MUMBAI | Sad Case

A study carried out at IIT-Bombay shows that most Indians are unhappy with their lives. Research student Tithi Bhatnagar carried out the independent study under Meenakshi Gupta, head of the department, humanities, IIT-B. The seven-year study on subjective well-being was conducted on 2,600 people aged five to 92. Bhatnagar says, "The study was trying to find out how people evaluate their lives." It was found that relationships are the most important factor in Indian well-being.

by Nishat Bari

MUMBAI | Showing the Way

Maharashtra's ambitious Innovation Park project is finally about to be inaugurated in Roha in Raigad district. This one-of-its-kind technological hub will aim to create an integrated research network with 2,500 scientists from 100 countries working in fields such as nanotechnology, green fuels and pharmacy. The park will employ over eight lakh people and is expected to be built over five years. Private developers will have a 74 per cent stake in the project while the the Mumbai Metropolitan Regional Development Authority (MMRDA) will hold 26 per cent. "We aim to work in applied sciences that can be useful to real industries," says D.N. Kavathkar, public relations officer, MMRDA.

by Mitali Patel

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PARLIAMENTARIANS' MONTHLY SALARIES ARE SET TO RISE FIVE-FOLD TO RS 80,000.

DELHI | Pay Check

Members of Parliament are going to get richer. The joint committee of the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha has proposed a five-fold hike in MPs' salaries: from the current Rs16,000 per month to Rs 80,000 per month. The MPs' daily allowance may also be doubled. And there's more. If the proposals are through, an MPs' annual allowance for telephone calls will also be hiked from Rs 1.5 lakh to Rs 2 lakh. The proposal is under consideration at the Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs. What will cost the exchequer even more is the MPs' travel allowance. An MP can avail free air travel and can claim 25 per cent more of the actual airline fare, even if he travels by train. Sources in the ministry say that there is no urgency to amend this rule.

by Shyam Lal Yadav



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